Practical 7: PHP Form Processing with Server-Side Validation and CSV/JSON File Storage
Problem Definition Process submitted registration/contact form data using PHP. Validate and sanitize inputs on the server side and store records in CSV or JSON file
format. Display success/error messages.

Key Questions / Analysis
/ Interpretation

1. Is the form submitted using POST?

Yes. The registration form uses method="POST" and sends data to php/register.php using the action attribute. POST sends form data in the request body rather than putting it in the URL.

2. Are inputs validated and sanitized server side?

Yes. PHP validates the data on the server, even if client-side JavaScript validation is bypassed.

- trim() removes surrounding whitespace.
- filter_var() validates the email address.
- preg_match() checks the 10-digit mobile number.
- Password comparison checks whether both passwords match.
- in_array() validates the selected course, year and gender.
- htmlspecialchars() escapes output when displaying error messages.

3. Is file writing handled safely?

Yes. The implementation uses:

- fopen() to open or create the CSV file.
- flock() to lock the file during writing and reduce concurrent-write conflicts.
- fputcsv() to write records in CSV format.
- password_hash() to store a password hash instead of the original password.
- fclose() and flock(..., LOCK_UN) to release resources and the file lock.

4. Are success and error responses displayed clearly?

Yes. If registration succeeds, PHP redirects the user to the dashboard. If validation or file storage fails, PHP displays an appropriate error message.

B. Implementation/ Output/Result

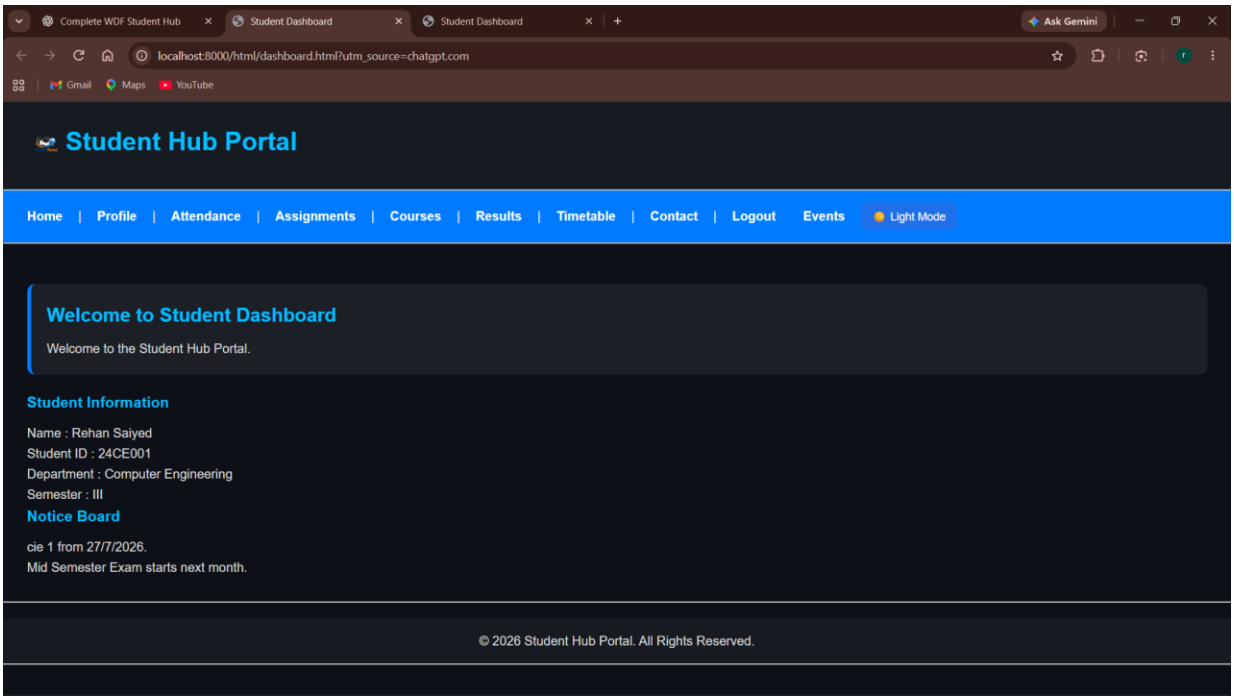
```
PS C:\Users\rehan\Documents\wdf\PRAC1WDF> php -S localhost:8000
[Tue Oct 20 16:36:38 2026] PHP 8.5.11 Development Server (http://localhost:8000) started
```

Result

In this practical I used php to local host website and save data in csv file

Name	Email	Mobile	Password	Course	Year	Gender	Registered
MALIVADA	25dce013(	6.35E+09	$2y$12$1a	CE	2	Male	########
MALIVADA	25dce013(	6.35E+09	$2y$12$qC	CE	2	Male	########

C. Evidence of



D. GitHub Repository Link:

GitHub Repository: https://github.com/rehansaiyed72/student-hub-portal

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E. Challenges Faced:

I learned we should not have first line of php file blank

F. Learning Outcomes:

I understand to use php to extract data in csv file